SSC MTS 2023 question paper with answers

12 September 2023 · Shift 1

49 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: 3 marks a question; no negative marking in Session-I (Numerical and Mathematical Ability, Reasoning), 1 mark deducted for each wrong answer in Session-II (General Awareness, English).

The other 41 of the paper's 90 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20231223070914/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/Writeup_MTS2023_22122023.pdf

Numerical and Mathematical Ability 1 question

Q.14

The monthly income of a person was ₹27,000 and his monthly expenditure was ₹18,000. In the next year, his income increased by 28% and his expenditure increased by 14%. Find the percentage increase in his savings.

(A) 51.5%
(B) 61.5%
(C) 56%
(D) 50.5%

General Awareness 23 questions

Q.2

How long can a person remain a minister without being a member of either House of the State Legislature?

(A) 15 days
(B) 6 months
(C) 1 year
(D) 2 months

Q.3

The world’s largest camel fair is held in which of the following cities?

(A) Bikaner
(B) Pushkar
(C) Barmer
(D) Udaipur

Q.4

Who among the following Indian musicians is the inventor of Mohan Veena?

(A) Totaram Sharma
(B) Braj Bhushan Kabra
(C) Pandit Vishwa Mohan Bhatt
(D) Sandeep Das

Q.5

Mulk Raj Anand is the author of _____.

(A) The Guide
(B) Untouchable
(C) The Invisible Man
(D) A Passage to India

Q.6

Which of the following musicians of medieval India is referred to as ‘Tuti-e-Hind’ and is also regarded as the father of qawwali?

(A) Miyan Tansen
(B) Amir Khusrau
(C) Purandara Dasa
(D) Swami Haridas

Q.7

The blue green alga Anabaena lives in the leaves of Azolla, a freshwater fern, forming which of the following relationships?

(A) Autotrophic
(B) Symbiotic
(C) Parasitic
(D) Saprophytic

Q.8

Who was famous for publishing a formula in 1827 that shows the mathematical relationship between current, resistance and voltage?

(A) William Gilbert
(B) William Watson
(C) Gustav Kirchhoff
(D) Georg Simon Ohm

Q.9

Identify the correct pair (name of shifting agriculture and related state) from the following.

(A) Bewar – Madhya Pradesh
(B) Kuruwa – Punjab
(C) Podu – Tamil Nadu
(D) Bringa – Uttar Pradesh

Q.10

The Balti dance of _____ is distinct as it has its own costume, music and songs in the Balti language. The dance is only performed on rare occasions, such as feasts or celebrations.

(A) Uttarakhand
(B) Ladakh
(C) Kashmir
(D) Himachal Pradesh

Q.11

The Fundamental Duties of Indian Citizens were adopted from the Constitution of which country?

(A) Soviet Union
(B) Japan
(C) United Kingdom
(D) United States of America

Q.12

Which state hosted the 36th National Games of India?

(A) Maharashtra
(B) Karnataka
(C) Gujarat
(D) Punjab

Q.13

Jet streams are a particular form of:

(A) weather fronts
(B) atmospheric pollution
(C) geostrophic winds
(D) periodic water motion

Q.14

According to the Global Multidimensional Poverty Index Report 2022, a total of 415 million people exited multidimensional poverty in India in the last _____.

(A) 15 years
(B) 5 years
(C) 10 years
(D) 20 years

Q.15

What is the primary function of a commercial bank?

(A) Issuing currency notes and coins
(B) Conducting monetary policy
(C) Granting loans and accepting deposits
(D) Regulating the money supply

Q.16
Which of the following is an example of revenue receipt in the government budget?

(A) Sale of government-owned land
(B) Repayment of a loan by a state-owned company
(C) Dividends received from a state-owned enterprise
(D) Borrowing money from international organisations

Q.17
Birsa Munda Hockey Stadium was built in which state?

(A) Gujarat
(B) Maharashtra
(C) Jharkhand
(D) Odisha

Q.18
Who received the title Pandita from the faculty of Calcutta University for her knowledge of Sanskrit?

(A) Rokaya Sakhawat Hossain
(B) Ramabai Sarasvati
(C) Sarojini Naidu
(D) Rash Sundari Devi

Q.19
Rani Machaiah from Karnataka was awarded the Padma Shri for her contribution to popularising _____ in and outside Karnataka.

(A) Kamsale Nritya
(B) Kunitha
(C) Karadi Majalu
(D) Ummathat

Q.21
Which of the following hills are located in Purvachal?

(A) Mizo hills and Naga hills
(B) Shevroy hills and Javadi hills
(C) Khasi and Jaintia hills
(D) Anai Mudi and Doda Betta

Q.22
The mausoleum of the Taj Mahal was designed by _____.

(A) Bhaktiyar Lahori
(B) Mohammad Isha
(C) Shah Jahan
(D) Ustad Ahmad Lahori

Q.23
What was the Swadeshi Movement called in the state of Andhra Pradesh?

(A) Gadar Movement
(B) Quit India Movement
(C) Khilafat Movement
(D) Vande Mataram Movement

Q.24
'Midnight's Children' is a novel by which of the following writers?

(A) Jane Austen
(B) Vikram Seth
(C) Chetan Bhagat
(D) Salman Rushdie

Q.25
Which of the following countries hosted the IBA Women's World Boxing Championships for the third time in March 2023?

(A) Hungary
(B) United Kingdom
(C) Malaysia
(D) India

English Language and Comprehension 25 questions

Q.1

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Castles in the air

(A) Unrealistic and impossible plan
(B) Unexpected change in the climate
(C) Realistic and possible plan
(D) Strong hope to get success

Q.2

Four words of the following sentence have been underlined and given as options. Select the option that contains a spelling error. Ongoing climate change, caused by the “acumulation” of greenhouse gases in the “atmosphere”, is happening on a timescale of “decades” to centuries and is driving “environmental” changes worldwide.

(A) environmental
(B) atmosphere
(C) acumulation
(D) decades

Q.3

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Laconic

(A) Reasonable
(B) Fanciful
(C) Concise
(D) Certain

Q.4

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. Make-up was _____ she hardly wore.

(A) anything
(B) something
(C) anybody
(D) someone

Q.5

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. The manager asked me “if I have completed my projects”.

(A) if he has completed my projects
(B) if I has completed my projects
(C) if I had completed my projects
(D) if I shall have completed my projects

Q.6

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. Pause indecisively

(A) Hibernate
(B) Hesitate
(C) Hoist
(D) Hobble

Q.7

The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error and select the option which rectifies that error. The SNAP-10 A / was launched on 3 April 1965 / on a Atlas-Agena D rocket / from Vandenberg Air Force Base.

(A) at Vandenberg Air Force Base.
(B) A SNAP-10 A
(C) was launch on 3 April 1965
(D) on an Atlas-Agena D rocket

Q.8

Select the correct spelling of the underlined word in the following sentence. He “dispised” the taste of black coffee.

(A) despisid
(B) disspised
(C) despised
(D) despeded

Q.9

Parts of the given sentence have been underlined. One of them contains an error. The underlined parts are given as options with some changes. Select the option that correctly rectifies the error. This car is “lesser” expensive than the “one” I had “come” “to” buy.

(A) for
(B) came
(C) ones
(D) less

Q.10

Select the appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Grasping at straws

(A) Futile attempts to win
(B) Desperate attempt to succeed
(C) Holding the last strands of straw
(D) Wasting time enjoying and relaxing

Q.11

Select the most appropriate idiom to fill in the blank. She told me, _____, that she was going to live in New York.

(A) blue blood
(B) black and blue
(C) out of the blue
(D) once in a blue moon

Q.12

Select the most appropriate synonym of the bracketed word in the following sentence to fill in the blank. The medical procedure was successful, but the patient experienced some minor _____(troubles) during recovery.

(A) applications
(B) complications
(C) transformations
(D) obligations

Q.13

The following sentence has been divided into four parts. Identify the part that contains an error. (A) It is said / (B) that fortune / (C) favour the / (D) brave.

(A) B
(B) C
(C) A
(D) D

Q.14

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. Teenage is that phase of life when “you are proposed to” the world outside.

(A) you are exposed to
(B) you are excited with
(C) one are proposed to
(D) you are interrupted to

Q.15

Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(A) Sergeant
(B) Playwright
(C) Experiance
(D) Leisure

Q.16

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. Ravi has little in _____ with his friend, Senthil.

(A) common
(B) contention
(C) formal
(D) normal

Q.17

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Dense

(A) Sparse
(B) Opaque
(C) Closed
(D) Thick

Q.18

The following sentence has been divided into parts. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don't find any error, mark 'No error' as your answer. The fight of the cobra and the mongoose / is a classic drama often seen in India, / and the outcome was largely the same.

(A) The fight of the cobra and the mongoose
(B) No error
(C) is a classic drama often seen in India
(D) and the outcome was largely the same

Q.19

The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error. The little child / wrote his name / quick / on the wall.

(A) quick
(B) wrote his name
(C) on the wall
(D) The little child

Q.20

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Bone to pick

(A) To be angry about something and want to discuss it
(B) To stop trying hard
(C) To not give up
(D) Putting in extra effort

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Health is the most valuable of all earthly possessions. Without it all the rest are worth (1)_____. To enjoy good health we should refrain from excess in eating. We should eat moderately and devour whatever (2)_____ get. When you sit among many for a dinner, do not reach your hand out (3)_____ of all. A little food is sufficient for us. Sound sleep comes of a light stomach. Such a man rises (4)_____ in the morning and is at ease with himself. So to (5)_____ good health we should eat moderately, for a man who does not overeat enjoys sound sleep and rises early completely refreshed.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 1.

(A) it
(B) nothing
(C) everything
(D) all

Q.22

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Health is the most valuable of all earthly possessions. Without it all the rest are worth (1)_____. To enjoy good health we should refrain from excess in eating. We should eat moderately and devour whatever (2)_____ get. When you sit among many for a dinner, do not reach your hand out (3)_____ of all. A little food is sufficient for us. Sound sleep comes of a light stomach. Such a man rises (4)_____ in the morning and is at ease with himself. So to (5)_____ good health we should eat moderately, for a man who does not overeat enjoys sound sleep and rises early completely refreshed.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 2.

(A) us
(B) he
(C) we
(D) it

Q.23

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Health is the most valuable of all earthly possessions. Without it all the rest are worth (1)_____. To enjoy good health we should refrain from excess in eating. We should eat moderately and devour whatever (2)_____ get. When you sit among many for a dinner, do not reach your hand out (3)_____ of all. A little food is sufficient for us. Sound sleep comes of a light stomach. Such a man rises (4)_____ in the morning and is at ease with himself. So to (5)_____ good health we should eat moderately, for a man who does not overeat enjoys sound sleep and rises early completely refreshed.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 3.

(A) first
(B) second
(C) last
(D) end

Q.24

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Health is the most valuable of all earthly possessions. Without it all the rest are worth (1)_____. To enjoy good health we should refrain from excess in eating. We should eat moderately and devour whatever (2)_____ get. When you sit among many for a dinner, do not reach your hand out (3)_____ of all. A little food is sufficient for us. Sound sleep comes of a light stomach. Such a man rises (4)_____ in the morning and is at ease with himself. So to (5)_____ good health we should eat moderately, for a man who does not overeat enjoys sound sleep and rises early completely refreshed.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 4.

(A) late
(B) early
(C) active
(D) idle

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Health is the most valuable of all earthly possessions. Without it all the rest are worth (1)_____. To enjoy good health we should refrain from excess in eating. We should eat moderately and devour whatever (2)_____ get. When you sit among many for a dinner, do not reach your hand out (3)_____ of all. A little food is sufficient for us. Sound sleep comes of a light stomach. Such a man rises (4)_____ in the morning and is at ease with himself. So to (5)_____ good health we should eat moderately, for a man who does not overeat enjoys sound sleep and rises early completely refreshed.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 5.

(A) lose
(B) benefit
(C) reward
(D) enjoy

Answer key

Numerical and Mathematical Ability

Q.14 **(C)**

General Awareness

Q.2 **(B)**	Q.3 **(B)**	Q.4 **(C)**	Q.5 **(B)**	Q.6 **(B)**	Q.7 **(B)**
Q.8 **(D)**	Q.9 **(A)**	Q.10 **(B)**	Q.11 **(A)**	Q.12 **(C)**	Q.13 **(C)**
Q.14 **(A)**	Q.15 **(C)**	Q.16 **(C)**	Q.17 **(D)**	Q.18 **(B)**	Q.19 **(D)**
Q.21 **(A)**	Q.22 **(D)**	Q.23 **(D)**	Q.24 **(D)**	Q.25 **(D)**	

English Language and Comprehension

Q.1 **(A)**	Q.2 **(C)**	Q.3 **(C)**	Q.4 **(B)**	Q.5 **(C)**	Q.6 **(B)**
Q.7 **(D)**	Q.8 **(C)**	Q.9 **(D)**	Q.10 **(B)**	Q.11 **(C)**	Q.12 **(B)**
Q.13 **(B)**	Q.14 **(A)**	Q.15 **(C)**	Q.16 **(A)**	Q.17 **(A)**	Q.18 **(D)**
Q.19 **(A)**	Q.20 **(A)**	Q.21 **(B)**	Q.22 **(C)**	Q.23 **(A)**	Q.24 **(B)**
Q.25 **(D)**					

Explanations

Numerical and Mathematical Ability

Q.14 · Answer (C) 56%

Savings were 27,000 − 18,000 = ₹9,000. Next year income is 1.28 × 27,000 = ₹34,560 and expenditure 1.14 × 18,000 = ₹20,520, so savings are ₹14,040, up ₹5,040: 5,040/9,000 = 56%.

General Awareness

Q.2 · Answer (B) 6 months

Under Article 164(4), a minister who for six consecutive months is not a member of the State Legislature ceases to be a minister at the end of that period.

Q.3 · Answer (B) Pushkar

The Pushkar Fair, held every year in the month of Kartik at Pushkar in Ajmer district, Rajasthan, is known as the world's largest camel fair.

Q.4 · Answer (C) Pandit Vishwa Mohan Bhatt

The Mohan Veena, a slide guitar adapted for Hindustani music with added sympathetic and drone strings, was created by Pandit Vishwa Mohan Bhatt.

Q.5 · Answer (B) Untouchable

Mulk Raj Anand's first novel, 'Untouchable' (1935), follows a day in the life of Bakha, a young sweeper. 'The Guide' is R. K. Narayan's, 'The Invisible Man' H. G. Wells's and 'A Passage to India' E. M. Forster's.

Q.6 · Answer (B) Amir Khusrau

Amir Khusrau, poet and musician of the Delhi Sultanate and a disciple of Nizamuddin Auliya, was called 'Tuti-e-Hind' (the parrot of India) and is regarded as the father of qawwali.

Q.7 · Answer (B) Symbiotic

Anabaena fixes nitrogen for the fern while living sheltered in cavities of its leaves, so both partners benefit: a symbiotic relationship.

Q.8 · Answer (D) Georg Simon Ohm

Georg Simon Ohm set out what is now Ohm's law, V = IR, in 'Die galvanische Kette, mathematisch bearbeitet' (1827).

Q.9 · Answer (A) Bewar – Madhya Pradesh

NCERT lists shifting cultivation as 'Bewar' or 'Dahiya' in Madhya Pradesh, 'Podu' in Andhra Pradesh, 'Bringa' in Odisha and 'Kuruwa' in Jharkhand.

Q.10 · Answer (B) Ladakh

The Balti dance belongs to the Balti people of Ladakh, chiefly of Kargil district; their language, Balti, is also spoken across the Line of Control in Baltistan.

Q.11 · Answer (A) Soviet Union

The Fundamental Duties (Article 51A), added by the 42nd Amendment in 1976 on the Swaran Singh Committee's recommendation, were modelled on the Constitution of the former USSR.

Q.12 · Answer (C) Gujarat

The 36th National Games were held in Gujarat from 29 September to 12 October 2022.

Q.13 · Answer (C) geostrophic winds

Jet streams are narrow belts of very fast winds high in the troposphere. There, away from surface friction, the pressure gradient force is balanced by the Coriolis force, so they blow parallel to the isobars as geostrophic winds.

Q.14 · Answer (A) 15 years
The UNDP-OPHI Global Multidimensional Poverty Index 2022 found that about 415 million people in India left multidimensional poverty in the 15 years from 2005-06 to 2019-21.

Q.15 · Answer (C) Granting loans and accepting deposits
A commercial bank's main business is accepting deposits from the public and lending them out. Issuing currency, monetary policy and the money supply are the central bank's concern (in India, the Reserve Bank's).

Q.16 · Answer (C) Dividends received from a state-owned enterprise
Dividends from a public sector enterprise are non-tax revenue, a revenue receipt: they create no liability and reduce no asset. Selling land, recovering a loan and borrowing are capital receipts.

Q.17 · Answer (D) Odisha
The Birsa Munda International Hockey Stadium at Rourkela, Odisha, was built for the 2023 Men's Hockey World Cup, which Odisha hosted at Rourkela and Bhubaneswar.

Q.18 · Answer (B) Ramabai Sarasvati
Ramabai, a Sanskrit scholar, was given the titles 'Pandita' and 'Sarasvati' by the faculty of Calcutta University in 1878; she later worked for the education of widows.

Q.19 · Answer (D) Ummathat
Rani Machaiah of Kodagu received the Padma Shri in 2023 for popularising Ummathat, the traditional dance of Kodava women.

Q.21 · Answer (A) Mizo hills and Naga hills
Purvachal, the eastern hills, takes in the Patkai hills, Naga hills, Manipur hills and Mizo hills. The Khasi and Jaintia hills belong to the Meghalaya plateau, the Shevroy and Javadi hills to the Eastern Ghats, and Anai Mudi and Doda Betta to the Western Ghats.

Q.22 · Answer (D) Ustad Ahmad Lahori
SSC's key gives Ustad Ahmad Lahori, generally credited as the chief architect of the Taj Mahal on the word of his son, Lutfullah Muhandis; Shah Jahan commissioned it. The later story of an Ustad Isa as its designer is poorly attested.

Q.23 · Answer (D) Vande Mataram Movement
In the Andhra region the Swadeshi Movement (1905-08) was known as the Vande Mataram Movement.

Q.24 · Answer (D) Salman Rushdie
Salman Rushdie's 'Midnight's Children' (1981), about children born at the hour of India's independence, won the Booker Prize.

Q.25 · Answer (D) India
New Delhi hosted the IBA Women's World Boxing Championships in March 2023, India's third time as host after 2006 and 2018.

English Language and Comprehension

Q.1 · Answer (A) Unrealistic and impossible plan
'Castles in the air' are daydreams: plans or hopes that are unrealistic and cannot come true.

Q.2 · Answer (C) acumulation
The correct spelling is 'accumulation', with a double 'c'.

Q.3 · Answer (C) Concise
'Laconic' means using very few words: 'concise'.

Q.4 · Answer (B) something
The main clause is affirmative, so 'something', not 'anything': 'Make-up was something she hardly wore.' 'Anybody' and 'someone' refer to people.

Q.5 · Answer (C) if I had completed my projects
After a past reporting verb ('asked'), the present perfect moves back to the past perfect: 'if I had completed my projects'.

Q.6 · Answer (B) Hesitate
To 'hesitate' is to pause before acting because one is unsure. To hibernate is to sleep through the winter, to hoist is to raise and to hobble is to walk unsteadily.

Q.7 · Answer (D) on an Atlas-Agena D rocket
'Atlas' begins with a vowel sound, so it takes 'an': 'on an Atlas-Agena D rocket'.

Q.8 · Answer (C) despised
The correct spelling is 'despised'.

Q.9 · Answer (D) less
'Lesser' is itself a comparative, used before a noun ('the lesser evil'); before an adjective such as 'expensive' the word is 'less': 'less expensive than the one I had come to buy'.

Q.10 · Answer (B) Desperate attempt to succeed
To 'grasp at straws' is to try anything, however unlikely to work, out of desperation.

Q.11 · Answer (C) out of the blue
'Out of the blue' means unexpectedly, without warning. 'Once in a blue moon' means very rarely and 'black and blue' bruised.

Q.12 · Answer (B) complications
Problems that arise during recovery from a medical procedure are 'complications'.

Q.13 · Answer (B) C
'Fortune' is singular and takes a singular verb: 'fortune favours the brave'.

Q.14 · Answer (A) you are exposed to
To be 'exposed to' something is to come into contact with it, as teenagers do with the world outside. To be 'proposed to' is to receive an offer of marriage.

Q.15 · Answer (C) Experiance
The correct spelling is 'experience'.

Q.16 · Answer (A) common
To 'have little in common with' someone is to share few interests or qualities with them.

Q.17 · Answer (A) Sparse
'Dense' means closely packed; its opposite is 'sparse', thinly scattered. 'Thick' is a synonym.

Q.18 · Answer (D) and the outcome was largely the same
The sentence states a general truth in the present ('is a classic drama'), so the last part must be in the present too: 'and the outcome is largely the same'.

Q.19 · Answer (A) quick
A verb is modified by an adverb: 'wrote his name quickly'.

Q.20 · Answer (A) To be angry about something and want to discuss it
To have 'a bone to pick' with someone is to have a complaint that you want to discuss with them.

Q.21 · Answer (B) nothing
Health is called the most valuable of all possessions, so without it all the rest are worth 'nothing'.

Q.22 · Answer (C) we
'Whatever ___ get' needs a subject pronoun, and the sentence is about 'we': 'We should eat moderately and devour whatever we get.'

Q.23 · Answer (A) first
At a shared dinner one should not be the first to reach for the food: 'do not reach your hand out first of all'.

Q.24 · Answer (B) early
A man who sleeps soundly on a light stomach 'rises early in the morning', as the last sentence repeats ('rises early completely refreshed').

Q.25 · Answer (D) enjoy
'Enjoy good health' is the usual collocation, used earlier in the passage too ('To enjoy good health'); 'benefit' would need 'from'.

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